



TAJ LAKE PALACE
UDAIPUR

THE TAJ LAKE PALACE, UDAIPUR

ENVIRONMENTAL

1. Accumulation of Plastic and metal waste
2. Lack of proper waste treatment leading to environmental degradation



SOCIAL

1. Unfriendly and hostile behaviour of the staff.
2. Lack of attention to customer grievances
3. Insincere and dishonest staff
4. Weak complaint resolution process



GOVERNANCE

1. Lack of management oversight
2. Inadequate supervision and access autonomy
3. Neglect of infrastructure maintenance (pigeon noise and poop)
4. Governance gap and lack of performance appraisal



Collection & Segregation



Processing & Sheet conversion



Miniatures & Showcases



Local Partnerships



Implement a systematic collection process for plastic and metal waste across the hotel premises. Collaborate with local recycling facilities and waste management companies to ensure efficient waste processing.



Invest in equipment to convert collected waste into hard and thick sheets. Use processed materials to create durable sheets. Craft miniatures of popular Indian places from these sheets and design other useful items, such as coasters, keychains, and decorative pieces, to diversify offerings.



Present these miniatures to guests as souvenirs, highlighting the hotel's commitment to sustainability. Display information about the recycling process and environmental initiatives in the hotel lobby and guest rooms. Offer workshops or demonstrations on recycling and crafting miniatures to engage guests and raise awareness.

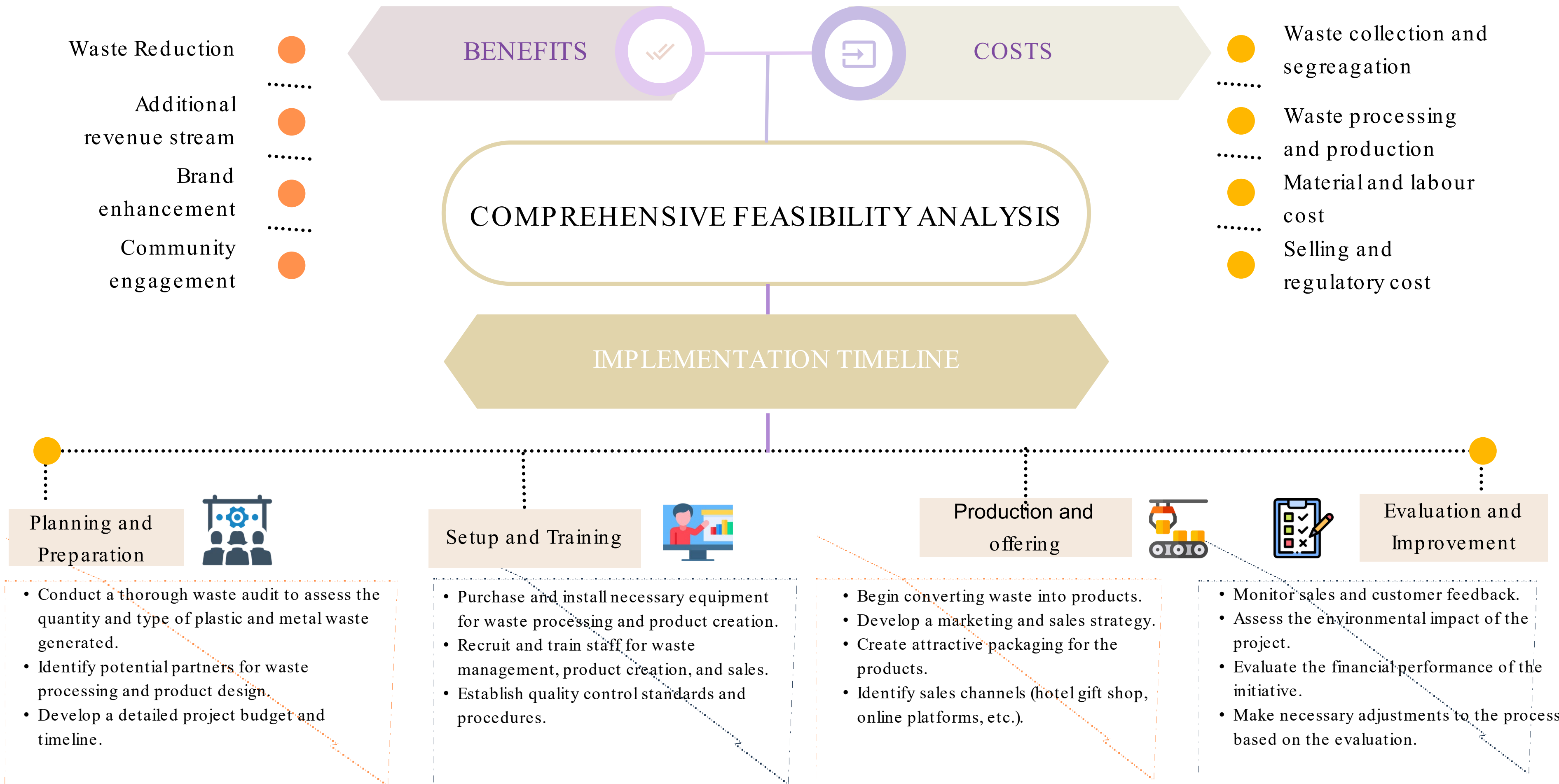


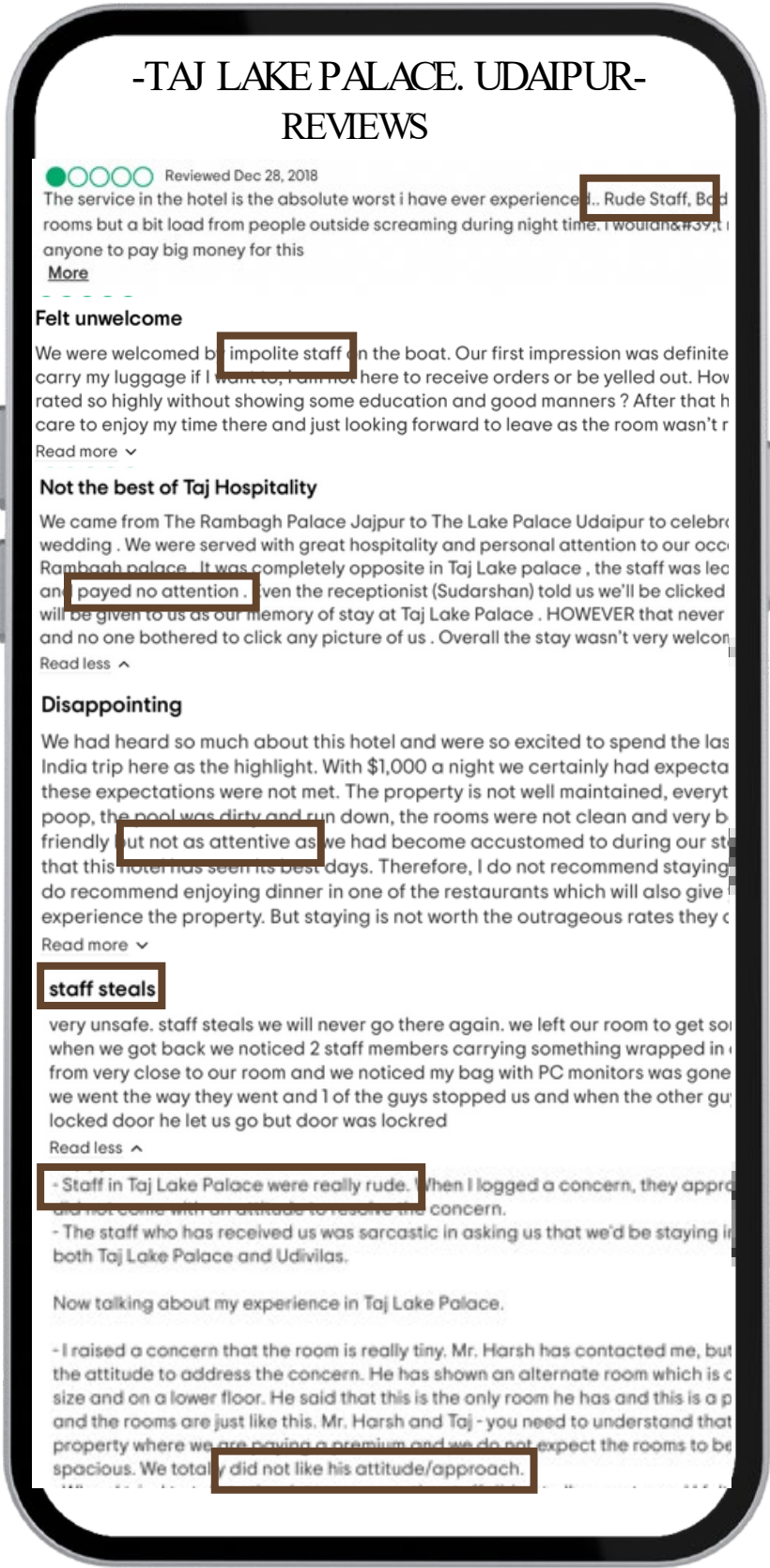
Partner with local organizations and communities to support the initiative and generate employment. Involve local artisans and community members in carving miniatures and creating showcase items, providing them with employment opportunities.



CONVERTING WASTE INTO OFFERING

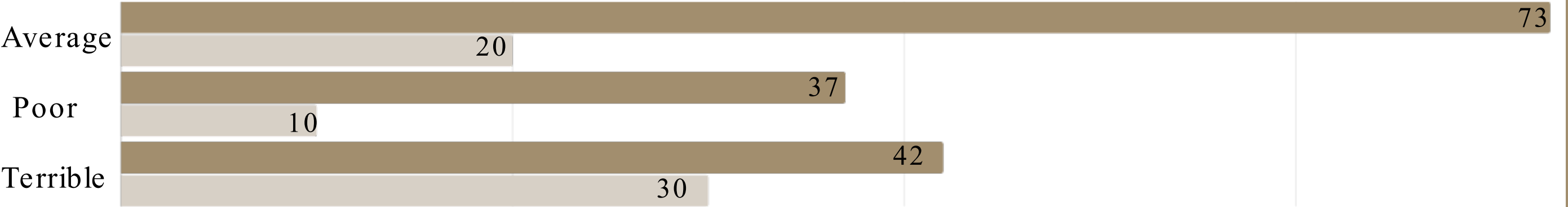






The Taj Lake Hotel has received consistent feedback about staff being unfriendly and inattentive. To address these issues, we propose a structured approach focusing on feedback collection, staff categorization, managerial oversight, and the implementation of a mystery shopper program.

Out of 152 total reviews, 60 were due to unfriendly and rude staff, which accounts for approximately 40% of the total feedback.



75% of terrible feedback is due to unfriendly staff behaviour

SOURCE- Tripadvisor

PROPOSED SOLUTION :

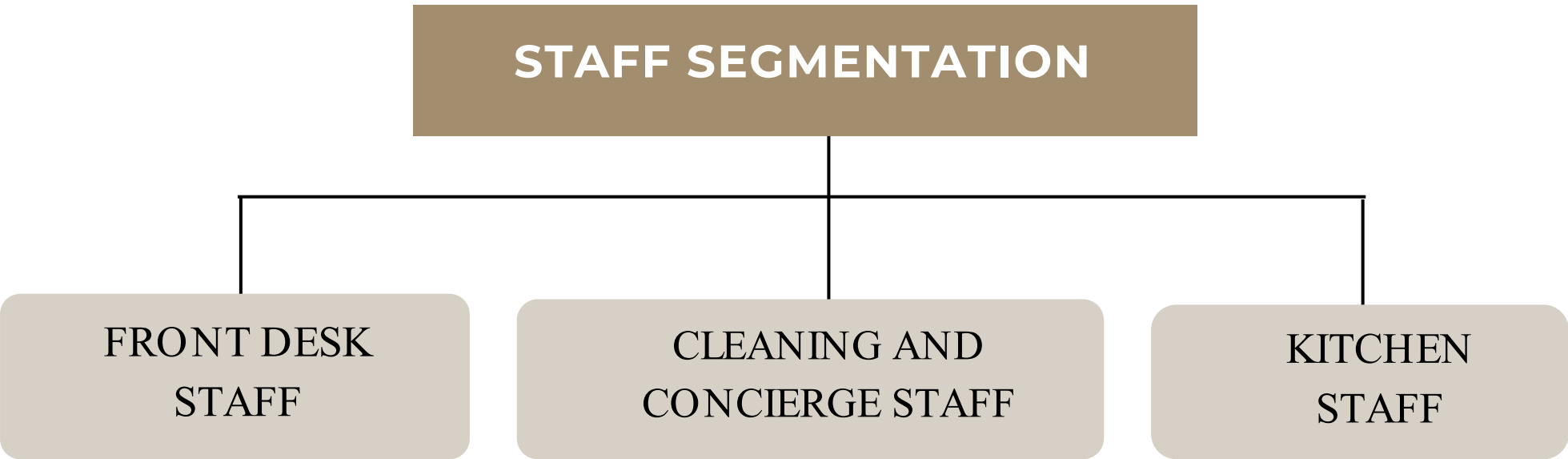
To effectively gather customer feedback, we propose the implementation of a comprehensive feedback system at Taj Lake Hotel. This system will function as follows:

FEEDBACK SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION:

- Guests will receive a QR code during their last meal to fill out a feedback form.
- For those in a hurry or unable to complete the feedback form, an email with a feedback form link will also be sent to ensure they have the opportunity to provide feedback at their convenience.

FEEDBACK FORM STRUCTURE:

The feedback form will include categorization of staff into three segments: front desk staff, cleaning and concierge staff, and kitchen staff. This will help us identify which staff members are responsible for any negative perceptions.

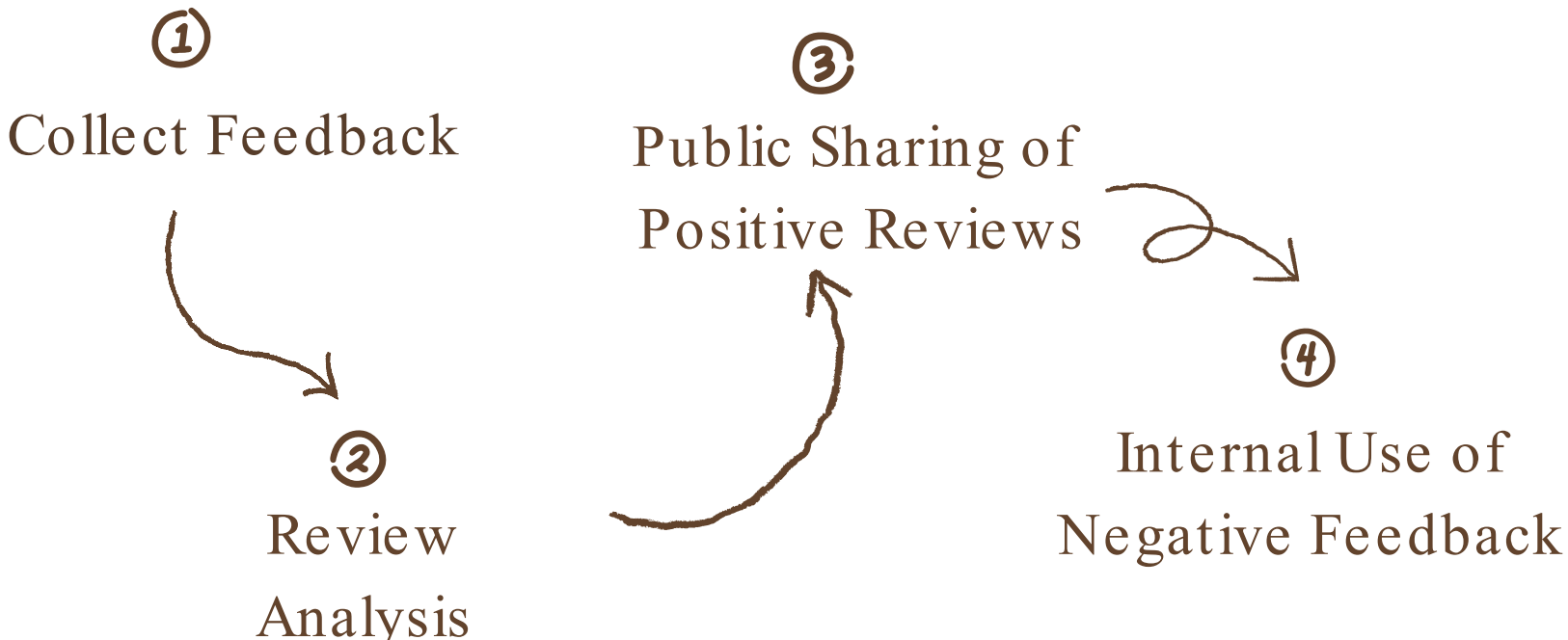


DEDICATED FEEDBACK TEAM:

A dedicated team will handle the entire feedback system. This team will be responsible for collecting, categorizing, and analyzing feedback and sending responses, and will report and update directly to the respective managers.

AUTOMATED AND PERSONALIZED RESPONSES:

- To enhance the experience, the feedback system will be equipped to send automated responses for common feedback to acknowledge the input quickly.
- For major issues, the team will send personalized messages to ensure that customers feel their feedback is addressed personally.



INTERNAL DATA PRIVACY

- Internal feedback system ensures negative reviews are not publicly visible.
- To share positive feedback publicly, we will create a section on the hotel's official website or social media pages dedicated to **guest testimonials and reviews**.
- We can promote the hotel's strengths while maintaining control over the visibility of negative reviews.

INTERNAL STAFF SEGMENTATION:

- Within the hotel, staff will be segmented into front desk staff, cleaning and concierge staff, and kitchen staff.
- Each segment will have a dedicated manager responsible for overseeing their performance and addressing any issues that arise.

PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL:

The feedback team will provide detailed reports to managers for these appraisals, The performance appraisal system will include:



360-Degree Feedback: Input will be gathered from peers, subordinates, and supervisors to provide a well-rounded view.



Development Plans: Based on the appraisal results, personalized development plans will be created for employees, focusing on areas of improvement and career growth opportunities.



Recognition and Rewards: Outstanding performance will be recognized through awards, bonuses, and other incentives to motivate and retain high-performing staff.

MANAGER RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Managers will oversee the feedback system controlled by the feedback team and ensure issues are handled efficiently.
- Managers will hold **periodic meetings** for two-way communication, reviewing both customer feedback and staff input.

MYSTERY SHOPPER PROGRAM:

- Mystery shoppers will visit the hotel anonymously and evaluate the service quality based on a predefined checklist.
- They will assess various aspects such as staff behavior, cleanliness and overall guest experience. It will be used to identify areas needing improvement, ensuring service excellence. This program will provide an unbiased view of the guest experience, helping to maintain high standards.



SOLUTION- GOVERNANCE



James Bond movie "Octopussy" has left the building. And the pigeons have moved in.

Oh well, many years have passed since Jackie Kennedy and Roger Moore have stayed at Lake Place. And the place still looks the same.

What Americans find "adorable" might look like slightly run down Disneyland set to modern Europeans. But that is of course all subjective.

What is objectively a major problem are the thousands of pigeons that live in this hotel. No matter how hard the staff tries, they have no chance to clean as quickly as the birds "do their business".

We moved out a day early because the smell and feel were not bearable. In combination with the rather old fashioned atmosphere this is a place we can not recommend and will not visit again. No matter how nice it looks an postcards.

[Read less](#) ^

Date of stay: February 2024

Trip type: Traveled as a couple



Stephanie F wrote a review Nov 2023
Sydney, Australia • 31 contributions • 6 helpful votes



Disappointing & living on past glory

I've dreamed of staying here since Oi saw Octopussy (back in the 80s I guess!). I was so excited to finally come here as the last stop of our 3 week trip in India - and am left feeling so disappointed, frustrated & let down that I cried. It started out very promisingly with a lovely little arrival ceremony. We were then told that our room had been upgraded & we thought - wow! We were shown around the premises - which didn't take too long. It certainly has a lot of charm & history & they're still living on the Octopussy thing. We were shown to our room which, at first seemed charming but stank overpoweringly of really strong, heavy, horrible floral (maybe rose and/or neolithic?) . I'm allergic to perfume & soon began to feel ill. I asked for whatever was creating the smell to be removed. But the smell remained even after various purifiers were used. We aïe currently waiting with the door open & fan going full blast to be able to consider going to bed. Meanwhile, we've had tome to notice more flaws. There may be a fine line between age & charm & tired & tatty but this room is clearly on the side of tired & tatty & given the thick layer of dust on the writing compendium, doesn't seem to get a really thorough clean. The "coffee & tea machine" that was pointed out is a kettle with tea bags & instant coffee. The blinds aren't effective, the bathroom old, damaged & unappealing. Compared to all the other hotels we've enjoyed in India, the service is lacklustre. Instead of meticulously laid out mat & slippers at turn down, a plastic bag of slippers was thrown on the floor near the bedside tables. Not worth the money & an incredible let down.

[Read less](#) ^

Date of stay: November 2023

Trip type: Traveled as a couple



"In the Taj Lake Palace, a lack of management oversight, inadequate supervision, neglected infrastructure maintenance, and governance gaps hinder operational efficiency and guest satisfaction. We Propose a comprehensive solutions for sustainable improvement."



PIGEON NOISE SOLUTION

- 1.Bird Repellent Sprays: These sprays emit a scent or taste that birds find unpleasant, encouraging them to avoid the treated area. They are usually non-toxic and do not harm the birds.
- 2.Gel Repellents: These gels create a sticky surface that birds find uncomfortable to perch on. They do not harm the birds but discourage them from landing on treated areas.
- 3.Ultrasonic Repellers: Ultrasonic devices emit high-frequency sound waves that are unpleasant for birds but inaudible to humans. These devices can be effective in keeping birds away from specific areas.

IMPLEMENTATIO N

1. COST OF REPELLENT OPTIONS

A. PHYSICAL BARRIERS

Bird Netting
Cost: ₹85 to ₹255 per square foot.
Installation: ₹170 to ₹340 per square foot.
Spikes and Wire Systems
Cost: ₹170 to ₹425 per linear foot.
Installation: ₹85 to ₹255 per linear foot.

B. CHEMICAL REPELLENTS

Gel Repellents
Cost: ₹850 to ₹1,700 per tube (covers about 10 to 20 feet).

Spray Repellents
Cost: ₹1,700 to ₹4,250 per gallon (covers approximately 100 to 200 square feet).

C. ELECTRONIC REPELLENTS

Ultrasonic Devices
Cost: ₹8,500 to ₹25,500 per unit.
Sound Emitters
Cost: ₹12,750 to ₹42,500 per unit.



2. COST BREAKDOWN EXAMPLE



Assuming a mid-sized area of approximately 1,000 square feet and moderate pigeon infestation, here’s a rough estimate:

A. PHYSICAL BARRIERS

Netting: ₹255,000 to ₹680,000 (including installation).
Spikes: ₹127,500 to ₹340,000 (including installation).

B. CHEMICAL REPELLENTS

Gel Repellents: ₹17,000 to ₹42,500 for initial application.
Spray Repellents: ₹17,000 to ₹42,500 for initial application.

C. ELECTRONIC REPELLENTS

Ultrasonic Devices: ₹85,000 to ₹255,000 for multiple units.
Sound Emitters: ₹127,500 to ₹425,000 for multiple units.

The best solution will depend on the severity of the pigeon problem, available budget, and long-term effectiveness. Consulting with a local bird control expert can provide a more precise assessment and tailored recommendations for your specific needs at the Taj Lake Palace Hotel.

REDUCING GOVERNANCE GAP



1. ASSESS CURRENT GOVERNANCE PRACTICES

A. Conduct a Comprehensive Review

Evaluate Existing Procedures: Examine current operational procedures, decision-making processes, and compliance practices.
Identify Weaknesses: Determine areas where governance gaps exist, such as inefficiencies, lack of transparency, or inadequate enforcement of standards.

B. Gather Feedback

Stakeholder Input: Collect feedback from staff, guests, and suppliers to understand their perspectives on governance issues.
Guest Surveys: Use guest satisfaction surveys to identify areas needing improvement in service and management.

2. IMPROVE OPERATIONAL EFFICIENCY

A. Implement Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

Develop SOPs: Create detailed SOPs for key operations such as guest check-in/ check-out, housekeeping, and food & beverage services.
Train Staff: Ensure all staff are trained on these SOPs and understand their roles and responsibilities.

B. Upgrade Technology

Adopt Management Software: Implement advanced property management systems (PMS) for reservations, guest feedback, and operational management.
Use Data Analytics: Leverage data analytics to monitor performance metrics and identify areas for improvement.

3. ENHANCE TRANSPARENCY AND ACCOUNTABILITY

A. Establish Clear Reporting Structures

Define Roles: Clearly define roles and responsibilities for each position to ensure accountability.
Regular Reporting: Implement regular reporting mechanisms for financials, operational performance, and compliance.

B. Improve Communication

Open Channels: Create open communication channels between management, staff, and guests.
Feedback Mechanisms: Implement systems for guests and staff to provide feedback on governance practices and service quality.

4. STRENGTHEN COMPLIANCE AND RISK MANAGEMENT

A. Develop and Enforce Policies

Compliance Policies: Develop policies related to compliance with legal and regulatory requirements.
Enforcement Mechanisms: Ensure policies are enforced and regularly reviewed for effectiveness.

B. Risk Management

Identify Risks: Conduct risk assessments to identify potential risks related to operations, safety, and compliance.
Mitigation Strategies: Develop and implement strategies to mitigate identified risks.

5. FOSTER A CULTURE OF EXCELLENCE

A. Promote Ethical Practices

Code of Conduct: Establish a code of conduct for staff and management, emphasizing ethical behavior and integrity.
Training Programs: Provide ongoing training on ethical practices and compliance.

B. Recognise and Reward Performance

Performance Incentives: Implement a system to recognize and reward staff for exceptional performance and adherence to governance practices.
Career Development: Offer career development opportunities to motivate staff and enhance their skills.

TO EFFECTIVELY ADDRESS THEFT PROBLEMS AT TAJ LAKE PALACE OR ANY LUXURY HOTEL, A COMPREHENSIVE APPROACH INVOLVING PREVENTION, DETECTION, AND DETERRENCE IS ESSENTIAL. HERE ARE SOME STRATEGIES TO CONSIDER:

ENHANCED SECURITY SYSTEMS:

Surveillance Systems: Install and maintain high-quality CCTV cameras in public areas, corridors, and back-of-house spaces to monitor activities.

Access Control: Implement strict access control measures for sensitive areas such as supply rooms, cash handling areas, and guest rooms.

Security Personnel: Increase the presence of trained security personnel who are vigilant and proactive in identifying suspicious behavior.

EMPLOYEE SCREENING & TRAINING:

Background Checks: Conduct thorough background checks during the hiring process to screen for any criminal history or previous incidents related to theft.

Ethics and Integrity Training: Provide regular training sessions for employees on ethical conduct, the importance of honesty, and the consequences of theft.

Whistleblower Policy: Establish a confidential reporting mechanism for employees to report suspicious activities or theft without fear of retaliation.

GUEST AWARENESS :

Security Information: Provide guests with information on hotel security measures and encourage them to use in-room safes for valuables.

Feedback Mechanisms: Implement guest feedback mechanisms to gather insights into security concerns or incidents, allowing for timely responses and improvements.

BENEFITS OF ANTI-THEFT SUBSTANCES



DETERRENCE



IDENTIFICATION



EVIDENCE



INTRODUCING ANTI-THEFT SUBSTANCES OR TECHNOLOGIES INTO GUEST BAGS AT A HOTEL CAN BE A PROACTIVE MEASURE TO DETER THEFT AND ENHANCE SECURITY. HERE’S HOW IT CAN HELP AND HOW IT COULD BE IMPLEMENTED AT TAJ LAKE PALACE HOTEL:

IMPLEMENTATION AT TAJ LAKE PALACE HOTEL:

Selection of Substance: Choose an anti-theft substance or technology that is safe for guests and effective in deterring theft.
Options could include:

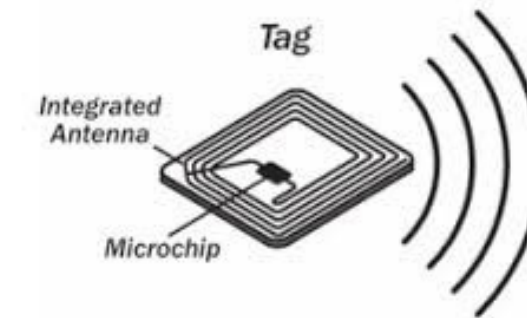
- Invisible Ink:** Mark items with invisible ink that is visible under UV light.
- RFID Tags:** Attach RFID tags to items, which can be tracked electronically if they leave designated areas.
- Microdots:** Tiny microdots containing unique identifiers that can be applied discreetly to items.

IMPLEMENTATION STEPS:

- Integration into Baggage Handling:** Incorporate the application of the anti-theft substance into existing baggage handling procedures. This could be done discreetly during luggage storage or handling.
- Training:** Train staff on the proper application of the substance, ensuring it is applied consistently and effectively without inconveniencing guests.

POLICY AND COMMUNICATION:

- Guest Notification:** Inform guests about the anti-theft measures in place, emphasizing their role in ensuring security and the hotel’s commitment to protecting their belongings.
- Consent and Opt-Out:** Ensure guests are informed and given the option to decline the use of the anti-theft substance if they have concerns.



2. COST BREAKDOWN EXAMPLE



A. INVISIBLE INK

Estimated Costs:

- Ink Purchase: ₹50,000
- Application Equipment: ₹30,000
- Labor Costs: ₹20,000
- Total Initial Cost: ₹100,000

B. RFID TAGS

Estimated Costs:

- RFID Tags (10,000 tags): ₹500,000 (₹50 per tag)
- Readers and Software: ₹300,000
- Installation: ₹100,000
- Total Initial Cost: ₹900,000

C. MICRODOTS

Estimated Costs:

- Microdots Purchase: ₹80,000
- Application Equipment: ₹20,000
- Labor Costs: ₹15,000
- Total Initial Cost: ₹115,000

TOTAL INITIAL COST FOR ALL MEASURES: ₹100,000 + ₹900,000 + ₹115,000 = ₹1,115,000

ESTIMATE ANNUAL COSTS

Invisible Ink: ₹10,000 (for replenishing ink and maintaining application equipment)
RFID Tags ₹50,000 (for system maintenance and software updates)
Microdots: ₹5,000 (for replenishing and maintaining application tools)

TOTAL ANNUAL COSTS: ₹10,000 + ₹50,000 + ₹5,000 = ₹65,000

ESTIMATE BENEFITS

A. REDUCTION IN THEFT LOSSES

Invisible Ink: Helps in identifying stolen items, reducing losses.

Estimated Reduction: ₹300,000 annually

RFID Tags: Provides better tracking and management of inventory.

Estimated Reduction: ₹500,000 annually

Microdots: Increases the likelihood of recovering stolen items.

Estimated Reduction: ₹200,000 annually

Total Estimated Annual Reduction in Theft Losses:
 $₹300,000 + ₹500,000 + ₹200,000 = ₹1,000,000$

B. INCREASED SECURITY AND INSURANCE SAVINGS

Insurance Premium Reduction: Enhanced security can reduce insurance premiums.

Estimated Savings: ₹100,000 annually

Total Annual Benefits: ₹1,000,000 (reduction in theft losses) + ₹100,000 (insurance savings) = ₹1,100,000

CALCULATE NET BENEFITS

Net Annual Benefit:

Total Annual Benefits: ₹1,100,000

Total Annual Costs: ₹65,000

Net Annual Benefit: ₹1,100,000 - ₹65,000 = ₹1,035,000

Initial Investment vs. Net Annual Benefit:

Initial Investment: ₹1,115,000

Net Annual Benefit: ₹1,035,000

Payback Period:

Payback Period = Initial Investment / Net Annual Benefit

Payback Period = ₹1,115,000 / ₹1,035,000 $\approx$ 1.08 years



Hotel Accomodation



Food & Restaurant



Hotel Services



Tour & Sightseeing

CONCLUSION

The cost-benefit analysis shows that the initial investment for implementing invisible ink, RFID tags, and microdots is ₹1,115,000, with an annual cost of ₹65,000. The estimated annual benefits of ₹1,100,000 outweigh the annual costs, resulting in a net annual benefit of ₹1,035,000 and a payback period of approximately 1.08 years. This suggests that the investment in these anti-theft measures is financially viable and beneficial in the long run.

